

Angelo Pignataro SC 3/c

Account of my travels
back home from
the Philippines.

Written in Diary
form to Mom &
Dad.

50171

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Transcription - Page 01

Angelo Pignataro SC 3/c

Account of my travels back home from the Philippines.

Written in diary form to Mom & Dad.

1.

Jan 4, 1946

We received orders today to return to the states & to report at San Francisco. It came as a surprise because we didn't get into dry dock yet. I can't explain how happy we all were. We needed fuel & water so we went to Leyte to get them. On the way the engine craped out & we were all pretty sore. In a few minutes the switchboard was going around that it would take 12 days to fix it.

Transcription - Page 02

Jan. 4, 1946

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2.

There goes our chance
of going home. Because
as soon as the base
command hears of it
they'll tell us to stay
here. But our captain
didn't radio in &
they went to work
to fix it. Its now
10 P.M. & I guess I'll
turn in.

Jan 5 1946

Awoke this morning
& the first thing I
heard was that the
engines were fixed.
That sounded pretty
good. We got under
way for Leyte again.

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There goes our chance of going home. Because as soon as the base command hears of it they tell us to stay here. But our captain didn't raise us & they went to work to fix it. Its now 10 P.M. & I guess I'll turn in.

Jan. 5, 1946

Awoke this morning & the first thing I heard was that the engine were fixed. That sounded pretty good. We got under way for Leyte again.

3.1

We arrived alright & got filled up in a few hours. Well have to leave tomorrow cause of some details. There weren't any movies tonight & the night was lonely & solemn. But I'll take it now that we're going stateside, I need to turn in.

Jan 6, 1946

Today we got started for home at 1300. I went to work as usual. At 1330 we finally got started. Everyone

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We arrived at night & got filled up in a few hours. We'll have to leave tomorrow cause of some details. There weren't any movies tonight & the night was lonely & solemn. But I'll take it now that we're going stateside, I need to turn in.

Jan. 6, 1946

Today we get started for home at 1300. I went to work as usual. At 1330 we finally got started. Everyone

4.

was up getting their
last look at the
Philippines. (I hope)
we're going pretty
slow because of our
bad engine. But as
long as we started
we don't care. We got
out of the harbor
into the open sea in
a short while we
couldn't see any land.
This noon most of
the men were talking
of getting sea sick,
so they did. They
were wearing for
hours. I can say
truthfully I feel

Transcription - Page 05

was up getting their last look at the Philippines. (I hope) We're going pretty slow because of our bad engine. But as long as we're started we don't care. We got out of the harbor & into the open sea. In a short while we couldn't see any land. This was most of the men were talking of getting sea sick, so they had their [illegible]. Seems funny, I feel

5.

funny, but I didn't
get sick. I guess
I'm an old salt
with sea legs. No
more mail for about
28 days I hear. I
didn't tell anyone
of my homecoming
because I want to
surprise them. But I
think I'll write at
Pearl Harbor & let
them know. I don't
want them to worry
because I'm not
writing. The trip will
take about 41 days
because of our engine.
We make only five

Transcription - Page 06

funny, but I didn't get sick. I guess I'm an old salt with sea legs. No more mail for about 28 days I hear. I didn't tell anyone of my homecoming because I want to surprise them. But I think I'll write at Pearl Harbor & let them know. I don't want them to worry because I'm not writing. This trip will take about 41 days because of our engine. We make only five

6.

stops. That's at
Eniwetok & Pearl Harbor
then to Frisco & the
ship is to be decom-
missioned & we might
get a 30 day leave.
The captain told us
that. I can't wait,
I'm so excited & glad
till tomorrow - good
night.

Jan 7, 1946.

The sea is still
very rough & the
men are still sick.
The ship's rocking
very bad. That's
because our holds
are not full of

Transcription - Page 07

stops. That's at Eniwetok & Pearl Harbor then to Frisco & the ship is to be decommissioned & we might get a 30 day leave. The captain told us that. I can't wait. I'm so excited & glad till tomorrow - good night.

Jan. 7, 1946

The sea is still very rough & the men are still sick. The ship's rocking very bad. They're reducing our holds are not full of

2.

cargo. Water is coming on the decks. The life lines were put up in case a wave hits you, then you can hold on. Our water has been rationed & its pretty tough. Its only on for 3 hours a day in one hour periods. We have to use salt water for showers & to wash our clothes. The laundry isn't working because of the water shortage. The water isn't exactly low but it has

Transcription - Page 08

cargo. Water is coming on the decks. The life lines were put up in case a wave hits you, then you can hold on. Our water has been rationed & its pretty tough. It's only on for 3 hours a day in one hour periods. We have to use salt water for showers & to wash our clothes. The laundry isn't working because of the water shortage. The water isn't really low but it has

8

to be used this way if we want it to last till Pearl Harbor, which is still about 26 days away. We'll be at sea a long time.

Jan 8 1946

Sea still rough when I awoke. A couple of guys fell out of their sacks. Went to work & here I am. Voyage is pretty slow & long. We can't make good speed because it might hurt the engines. Still no movies. I hear we'll

Transcription - Page 09

to be used this way if we want it to last till Pearl Harbor, which is still about 26 days away. We'll be at sea a long time.

Jan. 8, 1946

Sea still rough when I awoke. A couple of guys fell out of their sacks. Went to work & here I am. Voyage is pretty slow & long. We can't make good speed because it might hurt the engines. Still no movies. I hear we'll

9.

have them only on Saturday nights now because we only have 3 aboard ship. Water rationing getting worse. Salt water isn't good for laundry, found that out. I'll make mail now.

Jan 9, 1946

Water calm now & the ship isn't rolling much. Today we're having target practice to use the ammunition up. I fired the 30 caliber rifle, 20 millimeters, 30 caliber machine guns,

Transcription - Page 10

have them only on Saturday nights now because we only have 3 aboard ship. Water rationing getting worse. Salt water isn't good for laundry, found that out. I'll make mail now.

Jan. 9, 1946

Water calm now & the ship isn't rolling much. Today we're having target practice to use the ammunition up. I fired the 20 caliber rifle, 20 millimeter, 30 caliber machine guns,

10

3 inch gun & the 4
inch gun. The 3 & 4
make quite a bit of
noise. The 4 inch
has some flash too.
Everyone got a chance
at each gun. We
had some ammo
left over so they
threw it over the
side. The gunnery
officer said we
used more than
\$21,000 worth of ammo
& threw away about
\$6,000 worth. We had
orders not to bring
any ammo back
so we used it up.

Transcription - Page 11

3 inch gun & the 4 inch gun. The 3 & 4 make quite a bit of noise. The 4 inch has some flash too. Everyone got a chance at each gun. We had some ammo left over so they threw it over the side. The gunnery officer said we used more than \$21,000 worth of ammo & threw away about \$6,000 worth. We had orders not to bring any ammo back so we used it up.

11.

I sure was some
waste. But its no
good anymore. My
right arm is sore
from that rifle.
Till tomorrow - See
you soon.

Jan. 10, 1946

Well here it is Thurs.
night & time to write
days accounts. Woke
up this morning & the
sea was pretty rough
again. Its rolling like
peas in a tub. If
our ship was full
of supplies I would
feel much better. Today
we had a few drills.

Transcription - Page 12

It sure was some waste. But it was good [anymore]. My right hand is sore from using that rifle. Till tomorrow - see you soon.

Jan. 10, 1946

Well here it is Thursday & time to write today's account. Woke up this morning & the sea was pretty rough again. Its rolling like peas in a tub. If our ship was full of supplies I wonder how much better. Today we had a few drills.

12

They were, fire drill
abandon ship drill, &
collision drill. Everyone
has to wear a life
jacket now because
its so rough. They
were issued to us
the first day at sea.
After work I went up
for some more sun.
I got some tan now
and I'll lose it as
soon as I hit Frisco.
This will show you
how slow we're going.
So far we've only
gone 553 miles. We
still have 6,663 miles
to our first stop

Transcription - Page 13

They were fire drill, abandon ship drill, & collision drill. Everyone has to wear a life jacket now because its so rough. They were issued to us the first day at sea. After work I went up for some more sun. I got some tan now and I'll guess as soon as I hit Frisco they will show you how sun we've got going. So far we've only gone 553 miles, but still have 6,663 miles to our first stop

13.

at Eniwetok. We've been having a head wind all the way & also a strong current. That's not much traveling for being at sea for 4 days. At this rate we'll never hit the states. We got movies tonight. I know I'll enjoy it because I sure love to see movies. I'll let you know the name in tomorrow's story. We only see movies every week now on Thurs. Good night all & hope to see you soon.

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at Eniwetok. We've been having a head wind all the way & also a strong current. That's not much traveling for being at sea for 4 days. At this rate we'll never hit the states. We got movies tonight. I know I'll enjoy it because I sure love to see movies. I'll let you know the name in tomorrow's story. We only see movies every week now on Thurs. Good night all & hope to see you soon.

14.

Jan 11, 1946

Woke up this morning at 6:30 & the sea was pretty calm. I hope it stays that way. Still making very slow progress. Rumors going around that we have to stop at Guam. I hope it doesn't delay our trip. I'm very anxious to get to the states. Last night's movie was "What a Woman" with B. O'Hara & Ross Russell. Enjoyed it a lot. So long till Sat nite.

Jan 12, 1946

Well here it is Sat. night & still out at sea.

Transcription - Page 15

Jan. 11, 1946

Woke up this morning at 6:30 & the sea was pretty calm. I hope it stays that way. Still making very slow progress. Rumors going around that we have to stop at Guam. I hope it doesn't delay our trip. I'm very anxious to get to the states. Last night's movie was "What a Woman" with B. O'Hara & Ross Russell. Enjoyed it a lot. So long till Sat nite.

Jan. 12, 1946

Well here it is Sat night & still out at sea.

15.

The seas been the roughest today than it ever was. The Captain told us we're going to Guam for sure now. It will delay us about 4 days. At least we might get liberty there. We need food supplies. We ran out of fruits 3 days ago & vegetables 2 days ago. Food is very low. It might be rationed. The men are also flooding No. 1 & 5 holds to balance the ship. It's been rolling very bad. Lately. The screen comes out of the

Transcription - Page 16

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16.

water on every roll.
It's been running the
engine. We might also
get a tug at Guam
cause we're going to
slow.

Jan 13, 1946 At Sea
Well, we've been at
sea one week now &
it seems like one
year. Water still very
rough but ship isn't
rolling so much now
that No. 1 & 5 holds are
full of water. It's
safer now. We'll arrive in
Guam on Wed. We will
get liberty there. Water
& food still rationed.

Transcription - Page 17

water and every roll. It's been ruining the engine. We might also get a tug at Guam cause we're going so slow.

Jan. 13, 1946 - At Sea

Well, we've been at sea one week now & it seems like one year. Water still very rough but ship isn't rolling so much now that No. 1 & 5 holds are full of water. It's safer now. We'll arrive in Guam on Wed. We will get liberty there, water & food still rationed

17.

It's getting tougher
now. Having movies tonight
because we're going to Guam
& we can get more of them
good night.

Jan 14, 1946 at Sea
Well another day has
passed & I'm getting
closer to home. That's
all we talk about
now. Today was payday
because we're getting
liberty in Guam & we
need money. I didn't
draw all my money.
I'm saving it for when
I come home. Then I
can have a good time.
We started an anchor

Transcription - Page 18

it's getting tougher now. Having movie tonight because we're going to Guam & we can get [show] if them. Good night.

Jan. 14, 1946 - At Sea

Well another day has passed & I'm getting closer to home. That's all we talk about now. Today was payday because we're getting liberty in Guam & we need money. I didn't draw all my money. I'm saving it for when I come home. Then I can have a good time. We started an anchor

18.

pool today. We get 60 men
to put up a dollar each.
Then we got 60 sealed
envelopes with numbers
in them from one to 60.
Everyman puts his name
on one of them. When
we hit Guam & the anchor
drops its recorded to the
minute on the bridge.
So if its 4:35 the man
with the number 35 wins
\$60.00. We'll start one
for frisco soon for
\$5.00 per man. That's a
300.00 prize. We will
arrive in Guam tomorrow
I think. Then will find
out who has won.

Transcription - Page 19

pool today. We get 60 men to put up a dollar each. Then we got 60 sealed envelopes with numbers in them from one to 60. Every man puts his name on one of them. When we hit Guam & the anchor drops its recorded to the minute on the bridge. So if its 4:35 the man with the number 35 wins \$60.00. We're starting one for Frisco soon for \$5.00 per man. That's a \$300.00 prize. We will arrive in Guam tomorrow I think. Then we'll find out who has won.

19.

I finished a good book last night. The name was "Valiant Libertine" by John Bryson. It took me quite a while to finish it because I only can read it at night. It's the longest book I ever read. It had 627 pages. I enjoy reading now. At one time I disliked it. Will tell tomorrow nite.

Jan 15, 1946 - At Port-Guam
We arrived at Guam today after being at sea for 9 days. It was good to see land again. Guam is some place. It's the biggest Naval Base in

Transcription - Page 20

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Jan. 15, 1946 - At Port, Guam

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20.

the Pacific. There are over
a 100 ships in the harbor.
We were anchored near
the aircraft carriers
"Hornet" & "Saratoga". Besides
a few CVE's will be here
till Sunday then will begin
our trip home again. We
took the water out of No.
1 & 5 holds & were putting
150 aircraft engines
in them. We're also getting
supplies, water and [material]
in port & now we have
fresh water showers.
Till tomorrow night!

Jan. 16, 1946 - at Port - Guam

I mailed your letter
this morning & I know

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the Pacific. There are over 100 ships in the harbor. We were anchored near the aircraft carriers "Hornet" & "Saratoga." Besides a few CVE's. We'll be here till Sunday then we'll begin our trip home again. We took the water out of No. 1 & 5 holds & were putting 150 aircraft engines in them. We're also getting supplies, water and [material] in port & now we have fresh water showers. Till tomorrow night!

Jan. 16, 1946 - At Port, Guam

I mailed your letter this morning & I know

21.

you'll be happy when
you hear I'm coming
home. I had a hard
day today. Everyone had
to work to clean out
the 5 holds so we can
put cargo in. I put in
8 hours in the galley
& then 5 hours in the
holds. When we were
fueling up today I met
a buddy from boot camp
on the oiler tanker. His
name is Bill Horner. He's
stationed in Guam. He lives
in Jersey. We moved to a pier
today. At 8:00 P.M. I met
a fellow who was on here
in Leyte. He was transferred.

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you'll be happy when you hear I'm coming home. I had a hard day today. Everyone had to work to clean out the 5 holds so we can put cargo in. I put in 8 hours in the galley & then 5 hours in the holds. When we were fueling up today I met a buddy from boot camp on the oiler tanker. His name is Bill Horner. He's stationed in Guam. He lives in Jersey. We moved to a pier today at 8:20 P.M. I met a fellow who was on here in Leyte. He was transferred.

22.

He's stationed here also. He has a jeep & I was driving it all night. It's now 11:30 so I was driving for about 3 hours. Those jeeps sure can go. He's coming tomorrow again. I hope we shove off Sunday. Good night. x

Jan 17 - At Port - Guam
Well it's now Thurs. night & I just came back from the movies. I had a full day today also. I worked from 8 to 12 in the holds & then went on liberty & then I worked in the galley from 3 to 7:30 P.M. It sure knocks

Transcription - Page 23

He's stationed here also. He has a jeep & I was driving it all night. It's now 11:30 so I was driving for about 3 hours. Those jeeps sure can go. He's loading tomorrow again. I hope we shove off Sunday. Good night. x

Jan. 17 - At Port, Guam

Well it's now Thurs. night & I just came back from the movies. I had a full day today also. I worked from 8 to 12 in the holds & then went on liberty & then I worked in the galley from 3 to 7:30 P.M. It sure [knocks]

23.

a guy out. It sure is
swell ashore on
Guam. Swimming cokes
& beer, all you want.
I swam all afternoon.
Just like you see in
the movies. A nice white
beach - only ~~no~~ girls! -
Still loading up. That's
all for now.

Jan 18 1946 - At Sea Guam
Still loading up &
working like mad. I
didn't work so hard
since I came on here. I
had off tonight so I went
ashore. I went to a movie
on the Base. I seen "Pardon
My Past," with "F. MacMurray

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a guy out. It sure is swell ashore on Guam. Swimming, cokes & beer, all you want. I swam all afternoon. Just like you see in the movies. A nice white beach - only no girls! Still loading up. That's all for now.

Jan. 18, 1946 - At Sea, Guam

Still loading up & working like heck. I didn't work so hard since I came on here. I had off tonight so I went ashore. I went to a movie on the Base. I seen "Pardon My Past," with F. MacMurray

24.

That's the first picture
I seen that I enjoyed.
No breaks, no rain, no noise
& no separate reels. It
was shown at "Nab Hill
Bowl" outdoor theatre.
I also seen a U.S.O.
show with 5 beautiful
American girls. They
sure looked swell.
Rumors were leaving tomorrow
instead of Sunday. So
long.

Sat: Jan 19 - At Sea -
We left Guam this
morning at 0700. We
sure were glad to get
started again. Sea
is getting rougher

Transcription - Page 25

that's the first picture I seen that I enjoyed. No breaks, no rain, no noise & no separated reels. It was shown at "Nab Hill Bowl" outdoor theatre. I also seen a U.S.O. show with 5 beautiful American girls. They sure looked swell. Rumors we're leaving tomorrow instead of Sunday. So long.

Sat. Jan. 19 - At Sea

We left Guam this morning at 0700. We sure were glad to get started again. Sea is getting rougher

25.

tonight. Cargo got helping much. Still rolling.

Sun. Jan 20, 1946 - At Sea

Today makes 2 weeks at sea. We still got 6 weeks left till we hit Frisco. Engines still bad. Trip very slow. Last nite we found out that the ship is going to the East Coast after Frisco. I was happy cause its closer to home but it takes too long through the Panama Canal. Good old "B'klyn Navy Yard." Keep praying. xx

Mon. Jan 21 - At Sea

Today we found out what

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tonight. Cargo got helping much. Still rolling.

Sun. Jan. 20, 1946 - At Sea

Today makes 2 weeks at sea. We still got 6 weeks left till we hit Frisco. Engine still bad. Trip very slow. Last nite we found out that the ship is going to the East Coast after Frisco. I was happy cause its closer to home but it takes too long through the Panama Canal. Good old "B'klyn Navy Yard." Keep praying. xx

Mon. Jan. 21 - At Sea

Today we found out what

26

our cargo is. We got carbines, .45's, shoes, parachutes & Arctic coats. We're all trying to get one of each. I heard that song "Long Long Time" 3 times & I like it better every time.

Jan 22, 1946 - At Sea

Had a fire drill & abandon ship drill this morning. Sea isn't very rough now. Going very slow. Picture tonight was "Relay to Post" - [Isle Rappers]. I can't wait to come home. I hope we go a little faster. Good night x

Jan 23 - At Sea, Wed.
Last night I got my-

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our cargo is. We got carbines, .45's, shoes, parachutes, & Arctic coats. We're all trying to get one of each. I heard that song "Long Long Time" 3 times & I like it better every time.

Jan. 22, 1946 - At Sea

Had a fire drill & abandon ship drill this morning. Sea isn't very rough now. Going very slow. Picture tonight was "Relay to Post" - [Isle Rappers]. I can't wait to come home. I hope we go a little faster. Good night x

Jan. 23 - At Sea, Wed.

Last night I got my-

27.

self a - aviation jacket,
combat shoes & work
shoes (2 pair). No carbine
yet. I wonder if I can
get all this stuff off.
Expect to hit Eniwetok
Saturday. Then P.H., Frisco,
& N.Y. O'Boy!

Thurs. Jan. 24, 1946 - At Sea

Nothing new today! We're
going a little faster now.
It sure is a long trip.
I've been at sea for 19 days
now & I still have 3
times that much to do yet.
Tonight movie was "Chip off
the Old Block" W. O'Connor &
Ryan. Good night &
hope to see you soon.

Transcription - Page 28

self a aviation jacket, combat shoes & work shoes (2 pair). No carbines yet. I wonder if I can get all this stuff off before we hit Eniwetok Saturday. Then P.H., Frisco, & N.Y. O'Boy!

Thurs. Jan. 24, 1946 - At Sea

Nothing new today. We're going a little faster now. It sure is a long trip. I've been at sea for 19 days now & I still have 3 times that much to do yet. Tonight movie was "Chip off the Old Block" W. O'Connor & Ryan. Good night & hope to see you soon.

28.

Jan 25, 1946 - At Sea - Fri.
Sea getting rough again. Nothing new!
Reaching Eniwetok Sunday morning I hope we get mail. That's all.

Jan 26, 1946 - At Sea -
Today we found out that we're not going to the East Coast. Don't know I'm glad. It would have taken too long to go through the Canal.

Sun. Jan. 27, 1946 - At Port
Here's some more news. We were told today that we're going to be decommissioned in Frisco.

Transcription - Page 29

Jan. 25, 1946 - At Sea, Fri.

Sea getting rough again. Nothing new! Reaching Eniwetok Sunday morning I hope we get mail. That's all.

Jan. 26, 1946 - At Sea

Today we found out that we're not going to the East Coast. Don't know I'm glad. It would have taken too long to go through the Canal.

Sun. Jan. 27, 1946 - At Port

There's some more news. We were told today that we're going to be decommissioned in Frisco.

29.

on April 15th And
everyone has a good
chance of getting dis-
charged! I'll keep this
a secret for now from
your letters. Refused
promotion today to
S.C. 3/c. I always wanted
to be a petty officer.
Arrived at Eniwetok this
morning. Received 36 letters.

Mon. Jan. 28 1946 - At Port.

Went on liberty today.
I even had a Coke. Expect
to leave tomorrow. Wrote
some more letters home.

Tue. Jan 29, 1946 At Sea.

We got more fuel & water
this morning & shoved off.

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on April 15th. And everyone has a good chance of getting discharged. I'll keep this a secret for now from your letters. Refueled. Promotions today to S.C. 3/c. I always wanted to be a petty officer. Arrived at Eniwetok this morning. Received 36 letters.

Mon. Jan. 28, 1946 - At Port

Went on liberty today. I even had a Coke. Expect to leave tomorrow. Wrote some more letters home.

Tue. Jan. 29, 1946 - At Sea

We got more fuel & water this morning & shoved off.

30

Water rationed again.

-Wed-Jan 30, 1946 - At Sea-

Water rough today.

Ship still rolling. Going very slow. Movie tonight

"Girl Crazy". Making 92 miles a day! Unbelievable!

Thur. Jan 31, 1946 At Sea

Increased speed to 86 turns. If we keep up this speed will hit Pearl Harbor in 15 days instead of 20. Movie tonight "Sacred Stiff" J.M.

Fri. Feb 1st 1946 At Sea

Still going 86 turns.

Sea calm now. No movies

Sat. Feb. 2 - At Sea -

Nothing new! Trip

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Water rationed again.

Wed. Jan. 30, 1946 - At Sea

Water rough today. Ship still rolling. Going very slow. Movie tonight "Girl Crazy." Making 96 miles a day! Unbelievable!

Thur. Jan. 31, 1946 - At Sea

Increased speed to 86 turns. If we keep up this speed we'll hit Pearl Harbor in 15 days instead of 20. Movie tonight "Sacred Stiff." J.M.

Fri. Feb. 1st, 1946 - At Sea

Still going 86 turns. Sea calm now. No movies.

Sat. Feb. 2 - At Sea

Nothing new! Trip

31.

very boring. wish I
was home.

Sun. Feb 3 At Sea.

Cooked Turkey today
for crew. Same old news.
Date line passed Wed. this
week.

Mon. Feb. 4 At Sea.

Had target practice today
with .45 pistols. My ears
are still ringing. I also fired
the 30 rifle. Had a fire in
the Engine room today. No
damage - no one hurt.

Tue. Feb 5. - At Sea -

Sea very calm. Gaining
speed. Making 85 turns. The
Ship that's going back with
us ran out of food today.

Transcription - Page 32

very boring. Wish I was home.

Sun. Feb. 3 - At Sea

Cooked turkey today for crew. Same old news. Date line passed most this week.

Mon. Feb. 4 - At Sea

Had target practice today with .45 pistols. My ears are still ringing. I also fired the 30 rifle. Had a fire in the engine room today. No damage - no one hurt.

Tue. Feb. 5 - At Sea

Sea very calm. Gunnery week. Making 85 turns. They that going back with us ran out of food today.

32.

So they pulled alongside us
& we shot a line over &
sent them food. It took
us about 2 hours. We're
very short now on food
also. Water rationing cut
to 3 - 15 minute periods.
It's only on for 45 minutes
a day. It sure is getting
tough. So hang x

Wed. Feb 6, At Sea.

Today we ~~skip~~ go
back a day. So tomorrow is
Wed. again. 8 days in the week.

Wed. Feb 6. At Sea.

Today we got the oven
fixed & tomorrow we have
bread. I haven't eaten any
bread in 8 days. Just crackers.

Transcription - Page 33

So they pulled alongside us & we shot a line over & sent them food. It took us about 2 hours. We're very short now on food also. Water rationing cut to 3 - 15 minute periods. It's only on for 45 minutes a day. It sure is getting tough. So long x

Wed. Feb. 6 - At Sea

Today we lose a day & go back a day. So tomorrow is Wed. again. 8 days in the week.

Wed. Feb. 6 - At Sea

Today we got the oven fixed & tomorrow we have bread. I haven't eaten any bread in 8 days. Just crackers.

33.

Sea very calm, just like glass. Today we seen 6 whales. Began they beg.

Thurs. Feb 7 At Sea.

I've become the tailor man on here. I've made \$11.50 already sewing pants, rates & buttons. I can use the money cause I lost another \$50.00 in craps.

Fri. Feb 8 At Sea.

The ship going to the states with us broke down & we had to wait 6 hours for them. While we were waiting we caught 2 sharks. We seen more whales. Tomorrow personnel inspection. White uniforms & all. Today we failed inspection in the galley. We got 12 hours extra

Transcription - Page 34

Sea very calm. Just like glass. Today we seen 6 whales. Boy are they big.

Thurs. Feb. 7 - At Sea

I've become the tailor man on here. I've made \$11.50 already sewing pants, rates & buttons. I can use the money cause I lost another \$50.00 in craps.

Fri. Feb. 8 - At Sea

The ship going to the states with us broke down & we had to wait 6 hours for them. While we were waiting, we caught 2 sharks. We seen 100s whales. Tomorrow personnel inspection. White uniforms & all. Today we failed inspection in the galley. We got 12 hours extra

34.

duty cause of that. And we
spent 6 hours last night
cleaning up too. They haven't
any hearts. For the past 2
days were all been freezing.
And guess what the tempera-
ture was, only 79 degrees? Imagine
freezing in that warm weather.
But after spending 7 months
in the Phil. with a tempera-
ture of 100° to 120° anything lower
than that & we freeze. The doc's
been giving us some pills
so we won't catch cold. I
don't know how we'll take it
when we're in the states
& its about 40 degrees. Just
a blanked now.

Sat Feb. 9 1946 "Sea"

Transcription - Page 35

duty cause of that. And we spent 6 hours last night cleaning up too. They haven't any heart. For the past 2 days were all been freezing. And guess what the temperature was, only 79 degrees? Imagine freezing in that warm weather. But after spending 7 months in the Phil. with a temperature of 100 to 120 anything lower than that & we freeze. The doc's been giving us some pills so we won't catch cold. I don't know how we'll take it when we're in the states & its about 40 degrees. Just [blanked] now.

Sat. Feb. 9, 1946 - Sea

35

Today personnel inspection was strictest I've ever attended. Men were given extra duty for such things as, no buttons, shoe untied, not neatly pressed clothes, spots, etc. I was alright. We also took pictures of the crew dressed up. Expect to arrive in P.H. Mon Tue. morning.

Sun. Feb 10 At Sea
Weather getting cold again. Wish we had warm clothes. Getting my dress suit out for liberty in P.H.

Mon. 11 Feb At Sea -
Arrived at Pearl Harbor but couldn't go in yet.

Tue. 12 Feb - at Port Hawaii
Anchored th.

Transcription - Page 36

Today personnel inspection was strictest I've ever attended. Men were given extra duty for such things as no buttons, shoe untied, not neatly pressed clothes, spots, etc. I was alright. We also took pictures of the crew dressed up. Expect to arrive in P.H. Mon Tue. morning.

Sun. Feb. 10 - At Sea

Weather getting cold again. Wish we had warm clothes. Getting my dress suit out for liberty in P.H.

Mon. 11 Feb - At Sea

Arrived at Pearl Harbor but can't go in yet.

Tue. 12 Feb - At Port Hawaii

36.

Lost anchor pool which was for \$250.00. Got liberty today & the place is swell. Just like Frisco. Bars, dancehalls, taxis, everything. I send a Radiogram home to mom. I went to the Waikiki Beach & Royal Hawaiian Hotel & the Moana Hotel. All together I spent \$46.00. I have to borrow some more so I can go today.

Wed. Feb. 13 At Port Hawaii
Went on liberty again today & had a swell time. We all got drunk. I think I'll get out Saturday. I wish I had more money. Received 20 letters today. I'll write a few now.

Transcription - Page 37

Lost anchor pool which was for \$250.00. Got liberty today & the place is swell. Just like Frisco. Buses, shoeshine boys, taxis, everything. I send a radiogram home to mom. I went to the Waikiki Beach & Royal Hawaiian Hotel & the Moana Hotel. All together I spent \$46.00. I have to borrow some more so I can go today.

Wed. Feb. 13 - At Port Hawaii

Went on liberty again today & had a swell time. We all got drunk. I think I'll get [out] Saturday. I wish I had more money. Received 20 letters today. I'll write a few now.

Thurs, Feb. 14 At Port Haw.
 Went on liberty again.
 I can't get enough of
 liberty to suit me. Boy
 these Hawaiians are nice.
 Had pretty girls! A
 lot of American are too.
 I'll take either one. I can't
 wait to ^{hit} the states now.

Fri. Feb 15 At Port

7:30 A.M. Hawaii

It's now Sat. morning. I
 couldn't write last night
 cause I was unexpectedly
 taken drunk. I'm sober now
 though & liberty starts at
 9:00 AM this morning & I'm
 ready to go. I'm getting a
 tattoo today. I hope it ~~took~~!

Thurs. Feb. 14 - At Port Hawaii

Went on liberty again. I can't get enough of liberty to suit me. Boy these Hawaiians are nice. Had pretty girls! A lot of Americans are too. I'll take either one. I can't wait to hit the states now.

Fri. Feb. 15 - At Port Hawaii

7:30 A.M.

It's now Sat. morning. I couldn't write last night cause I was unexpectedly taken drunk. I'm sober now though & liberty starts at 9:00 A.M. this morning & I'm ready to go. I'm getting a tattoo today. I hope it [took].

38,

Sat. Feb 16, 1946 - Hawaii

I got paid today & I drew \$110.00. It won't last long. I never spend so much money in my whole life so fast.

Sun. Feb 17 - Honolulu

Stayed aboard ship today & rest up a bit cause I'm going on liberty tomorrow. I borrowed \$50.00 from my buddie.

Mon Feb 18 Honolulu Hawaii

I had swell liberty today. I bought some bell bottom dungarees, a lighter, belt, pictures & drinks. I spent 20.00. It was my last liberty cause we're leaving Wed for Frisco.

Tue. Feb 19 - Hawaii

Back from

Transcription - Page 39

Sat. Feb. 16, 1946 - Hawaii

I got paid today & I drew \$110.00. It won't last long. I never spend so much money in my whole life so fast.

Sun. Feb. 17 - Honolulu

Stayed aboard ship today to rest up a bit cause I'm going on liberty tomorrow. I borrowed \$50.00 from my buddy.

Mon. Feb. 18 - Honolulu, Hawaii

I had swell liberty today. I bought some bell bottom dungarees, a lighter, belt, pictures & drinks. I spent \$20.00. It was my last liberty cause we're leaving Wed. for Frisco.

Tue. Feb. 19 - Hawaii

39

liberty. Tomorrow we head home. Expect to pull in on 5 March at 7:30 A.M.

Wed. Feb 20. Hawaii

Bad news the engine craped out and we can't leave yet for 2 or 3 days. More bad news is they sent a last of men ashore of the low point men. I'm one of them. It looks as if I might be left here. And after spending 6 months in the Philippines. Boy am I mad. Went on liberty.

Thurs. Feb 21, At Sea

Left Hawaii at 4 P.M. This noon. They fixed the engine pretty fast. This morning we got a call from

Transcription - Page 40

liberty. Tomorrow we head home. Expect to pull in on 5 March at 7:20 A.M.

Wed. Feb. 20 - Hawaii

Bad news the engine craped out & we can't leave yet for 2 or 3 days. More bad news is they sent a last minute ashore of the low point men. I'm one of them. It looks as if I might be left here. And after spending 6 months in the Philippines. Boy am I mad.

Thur. Feb. 21 - At Sea

Left Hawaii at 4 P.M. this noon. They fixed the engine pretty fast. This morning we got a call from

46.

the beach to leave 13 low point men here. It sure was a rotten trick to play on the men. The captain said he was glad to hear we felt like killing him. The rest! I was lucky, I wasn't called cause I've been on here longer than most of the S 1/c & I have 3 more points than them.

Fri. Feb. 22 At Sea.

Since we left yesterday at 4 till 12 noon today we covered 165 miles. That's good for us. We'll make it in 43 days now.

Sat Feb 23rd At Sea.

Sea very rough today. The

Transcription - Page 41

the beach to leave 13 low point men here. It sure was a rotten trick to play on the men. The captain said he was glad they we felt like killing him, the rest! I was lucky, I wasn't called cause I've been on here longer than most of the S 1/c & I have 3 more points than them.

Fri. Feb. 22 - At Sea

Since we left yesterday at 4 till 12 noon today we covered 165 miles. That's good for us. We'll make it in 43 days now. x

Sat. Feb. 23rd - At Sea

Sea very rough today. The

41.

ship is rolling pretty bad,
and even walk straight. It's
also very cold out. I wouldn't
be with you and to us it is. The
picture tonight was "Ruffly
Haven". It was very good.

Sun. Feb 24 At Sea

The sea was pretty calm
today. We had a fire drill & a
abandon ship drill. We were
told today that we'd hit
Frisco in 7 more days if we
keep this speed. I hope so.
I miss you all a lot. Inspection
this Sat & Sun. I hope I pass.

Mon. Feb 25 At Sea

Sea very calm. Making
good progress now. Covered
213 miles today. O.K.!

Transcription - Page 42

ship is rolling pretty bad, and even water [strung]. It's also very cold out. It wouldn't do you good to see. The picture tonight was "[Ruffly Haven]." It was very good.

Sun. Feb. 24 - At Sea

The sea was pretty calm today. We had a fire drill & a abandon ship drill. We were told today that we'll hit Frisco in 7 more days if we keep this speed. I hope so. I miss you all a lot. Inspection this afternoon & sun. I hope I pass.

Mon. Feb. 25 - At Sea

Sea very calm. Making good progress now. Covered 213 miles today. O.K.!

42.

Tue. Feb 26 At Sea

Sea getting rough again. Weather very bad. Rain & fog for 2 days. This is Calif. weather now. Everyone's freezing. They finally issued jackets Bay an I sold. Did some more sewing. (5 more days.)

Wed. Feb 27 - At Sea

Sea pretty calm now. Rain still coming down. About 15 minutes ago the bridge spotted a distress flare & we're now on our way in that direction. They think its a downed plane cause of the bad weather. I'll let you know tomorrow - will waste a lot of time now.

Transcription - Page 43

Tue. Feb. 26 - At Sea

Sea getting rough again. Weather very cool. Rain & fog for 2 days. This is Calif. weather now. Everyone's freezing. They finally raised [jackets] Bay on deck. Did some more sewing. (5 more days.)

Wed. Feb. 27 - At Sea

Sea pretty calm now. Rain still coming down. About 15 minutes ago the bridge spotted a floating fire & we're now on our way in that direction. They think its a downed plane cause of the bad weather. I'll let you know tomorrow - will waste a lot of time now.

43.

Thur. Feb. 28 At Sea

We didn't find the lost plane, but we tried. Nothing new.

March 1st

Fri. Feb 29 At Sea

Sea pretty calm. I got a carbine last nite. I hope I can get it off. Just 3 more days.

Sat. March 2 At Sea

Inspection went over very good. The galley got 4.0. Very cold out.

Sun. March 3 - At Sea

Today personnel went O.K. We were in dress uniforms & held our unders, jumper on our arm. Very strict today.

Transcription - Page 44

Thur. Feb. 28 - At Sea

We didn't find the lost plane, but we tried. Nothing new.

Fri. March 1st - At Sea

Sea pretty calm. I got a carbine last nite. I hope I can get it off. Just 3 more days.

Sat. March 2 - At Sea

Inspection went over very good. The Galley got 4.0. Very cold out.

Sun. March 3 - At Sea

Today personnel went O.K. We were in dress uniforms & held our mattresses, jumper on our arm. Navy strict today.

44.

the sea was the roughest
its ever been. Every time
I go on deck I get a bath
its coming over the bow
& even the gunnells. The
weather seems like its
below zero. When it gets
rough at sea it really
stays rough. I hope it
calms down. We were told
to expect rough weather near
Frisco. We will pull in
tomorrow morning. Today is
our 58th day at sea from
the Philippines & tomorrow
is our last. I'll call up
as soon as I get ashore.
I'll also send a wire. I hope
for liberty

Transcription - Page 45

The sea was the roughest its ever been. Every time I go on deck I get a bath. Its coming over the bow & even the gunwales. The weather seems like its below zero. When it gets rough at sea it really stays rough. I hope it calms down. We were told to expect rough weather near Frisco. We will pull in tomorrow morning. Today is our 58th day at sea from the Philippines & tomorrow is our last. I'll call you as soon as I get ashore. I'll also send a wire. I hope

45.

I hope I get my leave soon as I'm very anxious to get home. I was told I'd make 3rd class petty officer before I got off. Well tomorrow is my last day at sea on this ship. It's being decommissioned & I'll get a new ship now. I hope I get discharged. No more water rationing. We were told we can wear a star on our Philippine Liberation for the work we did in near Luzon & for the air raids on our fleet. We're finally near the U. States.

Transcription - Page 46

I get my leave soon as I'm very anxious to get home. I was told I'd make 3rd class petty officer before I got off. Well tomorrow is my last day at sea on this ship. It's being decommissioned & I'll get a new ship now. I hope I get discharged. No more water rationing. We were told we can wear a star on our Philippine Liberation for the work we did near Luzon & for the air raids on our fleet. We're finally near the U. States.

46.

Mon. March 4 At Port
San Francisco, United States
After 59 days from
the Philippines we
arrived in Frisco at
0830 this morning. We
went under the Golden
Gate Bridge & it sure
looked good. I went on
liberty today & had a
swell time. I sent a
telegram to you. I spent \$20.00.
That's sure is little.
Altogether I spent \$37.00
on liberty. That's about
6 days combined. The
states sure look good.
But I still wish
I was home. Twenty

Transcription - Page 47

Mon. March 4 - At Port San Francisco, United States

After 59 days from the Philippines we arrived in Frisco at 0830 this morning. We went under the Golden Gate Bridge & it sure looked good. I went on liberty today & had a swell time. I sent a telegram to you. I spent \$20.00. That's sure is little. Altogether I spent \$37.00 on liberty. That's about 6 days combined. The states sure look good. But I still wish I was home. Twenty five men got discharged today. The ship sure seems deserted.

47.

five men got discharged today. The ship sure seems deserted.

Tue. March 5 U. States
we don't know when we're going to be decommissioned so I still don't know when my leave is due. I hope its soon.

Wed. March 6 U. States
Went on liberty today again. I hope I get my money order soon. I got a date for Sat. nite with Dolores. My buddy who lives here fixed it up for me. I sure will feel funny. We went driving

Transcription - Page 48

Tue. March 5 - U. States

We don't know when we're going to be decommissioned so I still don't know when my leave is due. I hope its soon.

Wed. March 6 - U. States

Went on liberty today again. I hope I get my money order soon. I got a date for Sat. nite with Dolores, my buddy who lives here fixed it up for me. The movie

48.

today & I had to learn
all over. But I got used
to it again. I sure like
to dance.

Thurs. 7 March U.S.
I received an answer to
my telegram & I have to
pick the money up at
San Francisco. We
moved today to Oakland.
We left Frisco cause
the piers were all taken.
No mail yet! Going
on liberty soon. Its
now 7 P.M.

Fri. 8 March U.S.
I picked up my money
order for \$50.00. It came
in handy. I had a date

Transcription - Page 49

today & I had to learn all over. But I got used to it again. I sure like to dance.

Thurs. 7 March - U. St.

I received an answer to my telegram & I have to pick the money up at San Francisco. We moved today to Oakland. We left Frisco cause the piers were all taken. No mail yet! Going on liberty soon. Its now 7 P.M.

Fri. 8 March - U.S.

I picked up my money order for \$50.00. It came in handy. I had a date

49.

today & it was swell. My
buddy lives here & he
got an extra girl. Thats
the first girl I kissed in
10 months.

Sat 9 March San Frisco
Just wrote 4 letters home
& one to Marie. The weather
very cold. Its foggy all
the time. Rumor going around
that all leaves are cancelled.
I'll kill somebody if they
are.

Sun. 10 March Oakland
Weather still foggy &
cold. Nothing to do. No liberty
today.

Mon 11 March Out in
Harbor

Transcription - Page 50

today & it was swell. My buddy lives here & he got an extra girl. Thats the first girl I kissed in 10 months.

Sat. 9 March - San Frisco

Just wrote 4 letters home & one to Marie. The weather very cold. Its foggy all the time. Rumor going around that all leaves are cancelled. I'll kill somebody if they are.

Sun. 10 March - Oakland

Weather still foggy & cold. Nothing to do. No liberty today.

Mon. 11 March - Out in Harbor

50,

Tue 12 March - Still waiting
 Wed 13 March - Still waiting
 Thur 14 March - Same
 Fri 15 March - Pay day
 Sat 16 March - Nothing
 Sun 17 " Liberty & Olive
 Mon 18 " " "
 Tue 19 " " "
 Wed 20 " " "
 Thur 21 " " "
 Fri 22 " " "
 Sat 23 " " "
 Sun 24 " Liberty with Olive
~~Mon 25~~ received ring from her.
 Had a swell time.
 Mon 25 - worked
 Tues 26. Liberty with Olive
 Wed 27. Seen Olive at Home
 Thur 28. Liberty & Olive

Transcription - Page 51

Tue. 12 March - Still waiting
 Wed. 13 March - Still waiting
 Thur. 14 March - Same
 Fri. 15 March - Pay day
 Sat. 16 March - Nothing
 Sun. 17 March - Liberty [with Olive]
 Mon. 18 March - [same]
 Tue. 19 March - [same]
 Wed. 20 March - [same]
 Thur. 21 March - [same]
 Fri. 22 March - [same]
 Sat. 23 March - [same]
 Sun. 24 March - Liberty with Olive. Received ring from her. Had a swell time.
 Mon. 25 March - Worked
 Tue. 26 March - Liberty with Olive
 Wed. 27 March - Seen Olive at home
 Thur. 28 March - Liberty with Olive